Theory reading guide

A reading plan for the 44 Herd theory cards (`herd-theory-cards.md`), the coaching sources behind them and the four Substacks in the Substack reading guide. Use it to write up each card properly before it goes out, and to get the ideas fresh in your own head before you coach them.

It has six parts:

1. **The write-up routine:** what to do for each card, in about 45 minutes.
2. **Six clashes to settle first:** where a Substack post disagrees with a card. Decide these before the card is finished.
3. **The pre-season read-through:** one theme a month from now until the season starts, so every source has been read once and the Phase 1 cards are finished before week 1.
4. **The in-season schedule:** every card in release order, with the week to write it, what to read and what to check.
5. **The library:** every source, where it lives, what it's best for and which cards use it.
6. **Substack posts by card:** the full list, with links.

Dates follow the 2027/28 season plan: week 1 is w/c 4 Oct 2027, and a card goes out on Discord a day or two before its session. ★ marks the Substack posts to read first for each card.

1. The write-up routine

Do this for each card the week **before** it's released.

1. **Re-read the draft card** (5 min). Note anything that feels thin or that you can't explain without notes.
2. **Read the sources** (15–20 min). Open each one on the card's Source line and read just the named section, not the whole thing. Then read the card's ★ Substack posts. The "Read" column in part 4 lists both.
3. **Write four lines per post** (5 min): *What it says / Where it agrees or clashes with our card / What we change / One drill or game.*
4. **Update the card** (5 min). Is each key point right? Is anything missing that a player needs? Keep it to three points; extra detail goes in Next level. Add each post you used to the Source line (for example *IF "When and Why Fakes Work"*), and put one Substack link at the end of Next level as "Read more".
5. **Do the diagram** (10 min). Pull it from the Ultimate Coach Figures folder or sketch it from the card's Diagram line.
6. **Check the links** (5 min). The drill links, videos and Read more link open, and the Try it session still matches the weekly plan.
7. **Publish and schedule** in the theory section.
8. **One line for yourself.** Write down the one thing from the reading you want to see at training that week. That's your coaching cue for the session.

Tick the card off in part 4 when it's out.

2. Six clashes to settle first

These posts disagree with what a card says now, so they make the best club write-ups. Read both sides, decide, and change the card before it goes out. The first three are on Phase 1 cards, so settle them before Christmas 2026.

Decided	Card	What the card says	The challenge	Decision to make
☐	**4 Fakes** (wk 1)	"A fake must look like the throw: full arm, eyes and shoulders."	★ IF When and Why Fakes Work: full fakes put *you* off balance and confuse your receivers; a dropped shoulder or the first few inches of a pivot is enough. ★ SF Great throwers don't pump fake: every pivot wastes balance and stall count, and fakes often cause handblocks. Follow-ups: SF Passing without pump faking, You can only fake at your defender's speed.	Rewrite key point 3 as "One real threat beats three fakes" and move the shimmy up from Next level into the main card?
☐	**10 First three steps** (wk 4)	Ladders and Hollywood squares are our speed work.	★ IF Footwork isn't Agility: change of direction (cones, ladders) is a closed skill; agility (reacting to a person) is open, and the two are trained separately.	Keep week 4's speed work but add a mirror or reactive 1v1 version to Try it, and point to Card 11 as where agility is trained?
☐	**20 Our marks** (wk 7)	Triangle mark by default.	★ SF Triangle marking is (mostly) nonsensical: it only looks good against throwers who pivot fully; good throwers use half-pivot breaks and curve around a loose mark. "Set a reasonably tight mark no matter what."	Triangle stays default for the 2s (who mostly face pivoting throwers) and the 1s move to a tighter mark sooner? This is also the defensive answer to clash 1.
☐	**15–16 Resets** (wk 14)	Reset reps under a live mark.	★ IF Diagnosing Reset Issues: reset turnovers are often a symptom of an offence that can't string passes together; check the offence before adding reset drills.	Mostly agrees with "every touch has a job" and BFD's Jedi. Add a line on checking the offence first?
☐	**24 Transition** (wk 22)	Sometimes get the disc to your best thrower.	SF Why I like fast breaks and Why everyone should pick up the disc: whoever is closest picks up. A few more first-throw turnovers, but better culture and skill growth.	"Nearest picks up" for the 2s and "best thrower" for the 1s at Regionals?
☐	**38 Sideline talk** (and 22) (wk 23)	Talk is defence; the sideline calls "up", "break", "strike".	★ SF Mildly against sideline communication: their sideline hears everything yours shouts ("never tell the sideline what the force is"), and constant chatter gets tuned out. Other side: IF Offensive Sideline Communication and Teaching Communication (communication "isn't a tap"; fix the barriers first).	Add "and nothing the opposition can use" to "information, not orders"?

Agrees with the cards: grip (Cards 4 and 8). IF Getting a grip (the thumb, hand size and strength matter more than finger positions) and ★ BL Why you should grip the disc harder both back Card 8's "extra-tight grip". Consider moving grip strength into Card 4 so everyone gets it, not just hucks.

3. The pre-season read-through (Nov 2026 – Sep 2027)

Why start now: 17 cards go out in the first ten weeks (weeks 1–10), three or more some weeks. That's too many to write in-season, so the plan is to read each theme once before the season and **finish the Phase 1 cards as you go** (marked ★ in the Cards column). The later cards only need a draft check now; you write them up in-season using part 4, which gives you a second, shorter read just before you coach them.

About two to three hours a week is enough.

Month	Theme	Cards (★ = finish now)	Read	Substack	Watch
Nov 2026	Start here, and how we coach	★1, ★2, ★3	BFD 1.2 (vocabulary); DK's Bible 6.11 (Five Frisbee Habits); WFDF pocket rules, rules 1.10–1.12, 9, 15–16, 18.1; start *The Inner Game of Ultimate Frisbee*; HN Amsterdam Conference: From Rookie to Baller, Process over Outcome; HN Coach Corner: Practicing Spirit, Getting out of your head, Zone of Proximal Development	All six clashes (part 2), so the changes can be made as you write; ★ Card 1–3 posts; IF Drills vs Games and the Constraints-Led Approach series; BL 'Mini' blog; the leadership-group posts in 6.8	—
Dec 2026	Throwing and catching basics	★4, ★5, ★6	DK's Bible 4.3–4.8, 9.12; BFD ch. 1; UAP Catching (Shardlow); HB 15.1–15.2; Flik L1 and L4; HN Point of Attack (The Shimmy); HN Excel Premium (Reading the Disc, Accuracy); HN Flik (Ideal Reception); HN Next Gen 10 (Winning Discs in the Air); HN Handler Offense (Moment of Catching)	Settle clash 1 (fakes) and the grip question; ★ Card 5–6 posts; SF forehand series	GRUT: Turn and attack, Rinkydink, Under-to-away, 20-20-20
Jan 2027	Breaking the mark and hucking	★7, ★41, ★42; check 8, 9	UAP Breaking the Mark (Saul); UAP Backhand hucks; DK's Bible 4.7, 4.9 and Breaking the mark; HN Practice Sessions 5–6 and 9; HN 10 Big Drills (Breakmark); HN Excel Premium (Improve your Hucking, Hucking with a Mark, Backhand Huck); Flik L4 Lesson 4; Flik Zone Offence 8	★ Card 7–8 posts (Bricklock's break-mark drill and throwing model)	GRUT: backhand and forehand huck, low-release session, Breakside flow, Read-the-defender; HN Deep Dives: Ring of Fire Hucking, Extreme Wind (Molly Brown v Phoenix), Firetails Downwind Offence
Feb 2027	Getting open and clearing	★10, ★11, ★12; check 13, 14, 43	UAP Changing Direction (Witmer); UAP Cutting (Raynor); HB Tr 14 and App. B; Flik L4 Lesson 3; HN Practice Sessions 1+2; HN Excel Premium (Cutting Class, Isolation Cutting, Common Mistakes, Principles, Game IQ, Fixing Focus, Deep Cutting, The L Cut, How to Jump); HN Flik (Cutting, When to Poach, Flashing the Lane); HB 27.3–27.5	Settle clash 2 (footwork vs agility); Card 11 is the biggest Some Flow cluster, so start with ★ Great cutters fake and do other things well too; ★ Card 12–14 posts	GRUT: Deep box-out, Find the body; HN Deep Dives: Italy Mixed WUC 2024

Month	Theme	Cards (★ = finish now)	Read	Substack	Watch
Mar 2027	Handling and resets	★27 (vert part); check 15–19	HB Tr 13, 25.1–25.4, 26.2–26.3, 34.2, 35.1, 36.3–36.4; BFD 1.2 (resets, Jedi); UAP Handler O and D (Wiggins); HN Handler Offense (Dump Swing, Give-Go Moves); HN Handler Situations; HN Flik (Sideline Resets, Upfield Dump, Give and Go, Sealing the Lane, The Dish, Scoring via Upfield Dump); Flik L3 Lesson 7	Clash 4 (resets); ★ Card 15–19 posts	GRUT: Tap-in, Leading pass drill
Apr 2027	Person defence and the mark	★20, ★21, ★22, ★44; check 23	UAP Marking (Wiseman); UAP Defensive Footwork (Matthews); UAP Handler D (Wiggins); DK (triangle marking); BFD (flat mark, S&C reaction work); HN Point of Attack (Triangle Marking, Marking Vert and Ho Stack, Marking from Motion); HN Practice Sessions 1–3; HN Excel Premium (Bail Step, Defending Away to Under); HN Next Gen 10 (downfield footwork); HN Team Defence (Heads-up D); HN Amsterdam Conference (Elite Defense: Mental Shift); Flik L4 Lesson 6; HB Tr 22	Settle clash 3 (triangle mark); ★ Card 21 and 23 posts	GRUT: Three marking tips
May 2027	Team defence and zones	check 24, 25, 26, 31, 32, 34	HN Team Defence (switching); HN Flik (Why Poach, When to Poach, Flashing the Lane, Disruptive Poaching, Buzz Switch, Zone Concepts, Arrow Head, 3-3-1 Japanese Poach); HN Bull Zone; Flik Zone Concepts 6; HN Point of Attack (Force Middle, Anti-Huck Force, Marking against Hammer, Marking Matchups); HN Coach Corner (Fast Break Principles, The Key to Fast Break Offence); Ian French (Help the Helper); BFD (Defensive fundamentals, zone counting)	Clash 5 (who picks up); ★ Card 24–25 posts; SF The Some Flow Guide to All Person (AP) Defense (long, about 4,800 words)	HN Deep Dives: Brute Squad v Traffic 2021, USA U24 poach, Swampybarg's cup zone
Jun 2027	Herd offence systems	★27 (front part); check 28, 29, 30, 33	HN Flik (Vertical Stack, Horizontal Stack, Undefended Channel, Peppermills and Banana, Handler Positioning, Pulling pages, Endzone Offence, Converting Short Hucks, Dump and Swing, Crashing the Cup, Zone Offence); DK 10.5, 6.3; SP (3H cutting); BFD (Dominator, "Alternate pistons"); HN Team Analysis (PoNY 2021); HN Excel Premium (Dynamic Pull Plays, Transitioning to your System, Converting in the Redzone); HB 26.4–26.5, 31.2, 33.3; Flik Zone Offence 1–3, 9	★ Card 27–30 and 33 posts (pulls are a strong cluster: start with Conor Hogan)	HN Deep Dives: Canada pull plays, PoNY v Revolver 2018
Jul 2027	Compete: decisions, mindset, game days	check 35–40	Finish *The Inner Game*; *The Culture Code* (Coyle); *The Captain Class* (Walker); BFD (performance model, Game plans, Team management, Training the sideline); HN Coach Corner (Preparing for Pressure, Time Outs, Base Metric Analysis); HN Case Studies (PoNY 2018, Mooncatchers 2024, CUSB 2019, Mooncatchers scouting sheet); Flik Case Studies (Ring 2021); HN Amsterdam Conference (Army of Dump Defenders)	Clash 6 (sideline talk); ★ Card 35–39 posts; the building-the-squad posts in 6.8	HN Deep Dives: CUSB v Clapham 2019

Month	Theme	Cards (★ = finish now)	Read	Substack	Watch
Aug 2027	Catch-up	any ★ card not done	Anything above you skipped	IF Coach Improvement in the Offseason, Season Planning	—
Sep 2027	Ready for week 1	all ★ cards published as drafts	Re-read Cards 1, 2 and 4 the week before the season	OTF The Team Charter before week 1	—

4. The in-season schedule

Every card in release order. **Write by** is the week before release, when you follow the routine in part 1. Cards marked ★ should already be done from pre-season, so that week is just a 10-minute re-read before you coach it.

The **Read** column lists the coaching sources first, then the ★ Substack posts (the rest are in part 6). The **Check** column is the one thing most worth getting right on that card.

Phase 1: Foundations (weeks 1–11)

Done	Write by (w/c)	Release	Card	Read	Check
☐	★ 27 Sep	Wk 1 · 4 Oct	1 The Herd Way	DK 6.11; BFD 1.2; HN Amsterdam (From Rookie to Baller, Process over Outcome). ★ OTF The Team Charter	The call table matches what the 1s split teaches in week 1
☐	★ 27 Sep	Wk 1 · 4 Oct	2 Rules and Spirit	WFDF rules 1.10–1.12, 9, 15–16, 18.1; HN Coach Corner (Practicing Spirit). ★ IF Teaching Rules, Officiating; ★ OTF Why do athletes take foul calls personally?	Stall restart numbers against the 2025–28 rules; hand-signal sheet attached
☐	★ 27 Sep	Wk 1 · 4 Oct	4 Grip, pivot and fakes	DK 4.3–4.8; BFD ch. 1; HN Point of Attack (The Shimmy); HN Amsterdam (Breaking a Defensive Heart). Clash 1 posts; ★ BL Why you should grip the disc harder	Clash 1 decided; "home position" is described the way coaches will say it
☐	★ 11 Oct	Wk 3 · 18 Oct	3 How we learn	*Inner Game* (Heckler and Hero chapters); HN Coach Corner (Getting out of your head; ZPD). ★ OTF The Power of Description, Building Description into Your Routines; ★ IF Drills vs Games	Lines up with the C1 classroom plan that week
☐	★ 11 Oct	Wk 3 · 18 Oct	5 Catching	UAP Catching; HB 15.1–15.2; HN Excel Premium (Reading the Disc); HN Next Gen 10; HN Handler Offense. ★ SF 95% of misreads are to the high side	GRUT drill links open
☐	★ 18 Oct	Wk 4 · 25 Oct	10 The first three steps	HB Tr 14; UAP Changing Direction; HN Practice Sessions 1+2; HN 10 Big Drills; HN Excel Premium (Cutting Class); HN Deep Dives (Italy Mixed). ★ IF Footwork isn't Agility	Clash 2 decided; week 1 5-10-5 times are filmed so the Feb comparison works
☐	★ 25 Oct	Wk 5 · 1 Nov	6 Throw to space	DK 9.12; Flik L1, L4; HN Flik (Ideal Reception); HN Excel Premium (Accuracy). ★ IF Good Bad Throws; ★ SF Always be offering	Diagram shows "throw here" vs "not here"; credit IF Golden Arm/Hand for Golden Hand
☐	★ 25 Oct	Wk 5 · 1 Nov	11 Getting open	UAP Cutting; UAP Handler O; HB App. B; Flik L4 L3; HN Excel Premium (Isolation Cutting). ★ SF Great cutters fake and do other things well too, Cut before the thrower catches it, Don't not get thrown to	The three cut shapes match the week 4 five-cone drill

Done	Write by (w/c)	Release	Card	Read	Check
☐	★ 25 Oct	Wk 5 · 1 Nov	27 Vert stack	HN Flik (Vertical Stack, Upfield Dump, Undefended Channel); DK 10.5, 6.3; SP (3H cutting). ★ IF Tactics aren't shapes, Tactics are Overrated	Back vs front explained in one sentence each
☐	★ 25 Oct	Wk 5 · 1 Nov	41 Backhand huck	GRUT huck video; UAP Backhand hucks. Grip posts (part 2)	Video link; post as homework, not a session card
☐	★ 25 Oct	Wk 5 · 1 Nov	42 Forehand huck	GRUT huck video. SF forehand series (part 6, Card 4), Why the palm appears up on flick hucks	Video link; post with Card 41
☐	★ 1 Nov	Wk 6 · 8 Nov	12 Clearing is cutting	UAP Cutting; HB App. B; BFD (field roles); HN Excel Premium (Common Mistakes, Principles); HN Flik (Cutting, Vert, Horo). ★ SF Clear out, don't check out	Active / inactive / ready space diagram; "Clear out, don't check out" as the Next level cue?
☐	★ 8 Nov	Wk 7 · 15 Nov	20 Our marks	UAP Marking; DK (triangle); BFD (flat mark); HN Practice Sessions 3; HN Point of Attack. ★ SF Triangle marking is (mostly) nonsensical	Clash 3 decided; flat mark stays in Next level until week 9
☐	★ 8 Nov	Wk 7 · 15 Nov	44 Marking: three GRUT habits	GRUT marking video	Post with Card 20
☐	★ 15 Nov	Wk 8 · 22 Nov	21 Defensive footwork	UAP Defensive Footwork; Flik L4 L6; HB Tr 22; HN Practice Sessions 1+2; HN Excel Premium (Bail Step). ★ SF Backpedaling, defensive awareness, and gaining an edge	Drop-step direction in the diagram
☐	★ 22 Nov	Wk 9 · 29 Nov	22 Reading the thrower	BFD S&C (reaction); UAP Handler D; HB App. B; HN Point of Attack (Marking from Motion); HN Amsterdam (Elite Defense). Clash 6 posts	Silent-points game is in the week 9 plan
☐	★ 29 Nov	Wk 10 · 6 Dec	7 Breaking the mark	BFD ch. 1; DK; UAP Breaking the Mark; HN Practice Sessions 5–6; HN 10 Big Drills; HN Next Gen 10. ★ BL Everyone should be using this drill to become elite, A model for improving at throwing	Refresh again before weeks 15 and 32

Phase 2: Pressure and trials (weeks 14–24)

Use the Christmas break (w/c 20 and 27 Dec) to write the three week-14 cards.

Done	Write by (w/c)	Release	Card	Read	Check
☐	20–27 Dec	Wk 14 · 3 Jan	15 The handler's job	HB Tr 13, 26.2–26.3; DK 6.11; HN Handler Offense. ★ IF Diagnosing Reset Issues; ★ SF You don't need to stare down your dump receiver	Dump-by stall matches the split sessions (5 for 1s, 7 for 2s)

Done	Write by (w/c)	Release	Card	Read	Check
☐	20–27 Dec	Wk 14 · 3 Jan	16 Resets	BFD 1.2 (Jedi); HB 25.1–25.4; HN Handler Offense (Dump Swing); Flik L3 L7. ★ SF Don't lose more yards than necessary on dump throws	Clash 4 decided; angles (45° negative, 30° positive) match Card 1
☐	20–27 Dec	Wk 14 · 3 Jan	36 Process over outcome	HN Amsterdam (Process over Outcome; Army of Dump Defenders); *The Culture Code*. ★ OTF Letting Go of Outcomes, Winning is a Finite Resource	Draft team priorities ready for C4; IF Training Journal as the process-goal tracker?
☐	3 Jan	Wk 15 · 10 Jan	28 Horo and dominator	HN Flik (Horizontal Stack, Peppermills and Banana, Handler Positioning); BFD (Dominator); HB 34.2; HN Team Analysis (PoNY 2021). ★ IF Tactics aren't shapes	Spacing numbers (9 m apart, 8–12 m deep)
☐	10 Jan	Wk 16 · 17 Jan	17 Beating a good mark	BFD ch. 1; HB 35.1; UAP Handler O and D; UAP Breaking the Mark; HN Flik (Scoring via Upfield Dump). ★ SF Catching with momentum towards the break side	One-crossover game rules are clear enough to run from the card
☐	10 Jan	Wk 16 · 17 Jan	19 Give-and-go and the dish	HB 34.2; HN Flik (Give and Go, Sealing the Lane, The Dish); HN Handler Offense (Give-Go Moves). ★ SF The go-to give-go resource	GRUT drill links open
☐	17 Jan	Wk 17 · 24 Jan	13 Reading the pitch	HN Excel Premium (Game IQ, Fixing Focus); BFD (Defensive fundamentals); HN Flik (When to Poach, Flashing the Lane). ★ IF Scanning the Field, Soft vs Hard Eyes; ★ SF Soft eyes, quiet eyes, scanning eyes	Game screenshots chosen for the water breaks; credit IF Develop Field Sense Through Video
☐	17 Jan	Wk 17 · 24 Jan	37 Performing under pressure	*Inner Game*; HN Coach Corner (Getting out of your head); Flik Case Studies (Ring 2021); HN Case Studies (PoNY 2018). ★ OTF You've got me feeling emotions!; ★ IF Trials and Selection	Lines up with C5, before trials; share "Trials and Selection" with players
☐	7 Feb	Wk 20 · 14 Feb	23 Downfield D	HN Next Gen 10; HN Team Defence (Heads-up D); HN 10 Big Drills (Win the Box); HN Amsterdam (Elite Defense); Flik L4 L6. ★ SF Why you shouldn't always play tight defense, Thinking carefully about defensive overplays	2s protection order agreed with the 2s coaches
☐	14 Feb	Wk 21 · 21 Feb	18 Getting off the sideline	HB 36.3–36.4; HN Flik (Sideline Resets, Upfield Dump); HN Handler Situations; HN Excel Premium (Common Offensive Mistakes). SF Caring about getting downfield of the disc	Four reset spots ranked in the diagram
☐	21 Feb	Wk 22 · 28 Feb	24 Transition	HN Coach Corner (Fast Break); HN Handler Situations; UAP Handler O and D (Transitions). ★ IF The key to fast break offence, EUCF Final: CUSB Break Efficiency; clash 5 posts	Clash 5 decided; fits the week 22 disc-overload session
☐	21 Feb	Wk 22 · 28 Feb	35 Good throw vs good decision	DK 6.11; BFD (performance model); HN Excel Premium (Common Mistakes; Fixing Focus); season plan (Measuring improvement). ★ SF Why do turnovers happen?	Decision-grid template is ready to hand out

Done	Write by (w/c)	Release	Card	Read	Check
☐	28 Feb	Wk 23 · 6 Mar	29 Pulls and pull plays	HN Flik (Pulling Strategy, Shapes, Technique, Training); HN Handler Situations (Fielding the Pull, Being the 2); HN Excel Premium (Dynamic Pull Plays). ★ IF Conor Hogan's Pulling Thoughts	Pull play names match the playbook
☐	28 Feb	Wk 23 · 6 Mar	30 Endzone and Spread	HB 26.4–26.5; HN Excel Premium (Redzone); HN Flik (Endzone Offence, Short Hucks); Kieran (Spread). ★ SF "Endzone!" doesn't need to mean "vert stack"	Both calls match the playbook
☐	28 Feb	Wk 23 · 6 Mar	38 Sideline talk	BFD (Team management; Training the sideline); Flik Zone Concepts; Hildo Bijl (feedback steps). Clash 6 posts; ★ OTF Do you practice communicating?, Adding Communication Practice to Drills	Clash 6 decided; standard calls list attached
☐	28 Feb	Wk 23 · 6 Mar	39 Tournament day	HN Case Studies (Mooncatchers 2024); HN Coach Corner (Preparing for Pressure; Time Outs; Base Metric Analysis); BFD. ★ IF Using Timeouts Effectively; ★ OTF Staying True to Your Team (re-read before Regionals)	Printable version for the team bag
☐	6 Mar	Wk 24 · 13 Mar	25 Poach and clog	BFD (Defensive fundamentals); HN Flik (poaching pages); HN Team Defence; HN Practice Sessions 11. ★ SF Stunt and recover	Introduced in week 17; the card goes out now
☐	6 Mar	Wk 24 · 13 Mar	31 Bull zone	HN Bull Zone; HN Flik (Zone Concepts, Transitions); BFD (zone counting). SF My summer league zone defense	Role table matches how the 1s run it; 2s version noted

Phase 3: Early season (weeks 25–37)

Done	Write by (w/c)	Release	Card	Read	Check
☐	13 Mar	Wk 25 · 20 Mar	9 Throwing in the wind	DK 4.9; Flik Zone Offence 8; HN Deep Dives (Extreme Wind; Firetails). No Substack posts on wind	Tour 1 wind plan agrees with it; refresh in week 30
☐	13 Mar	Wk 25 · 20 Mar	32 Arrowhead	HN Flik (Arrow Head; 3-3-1 Japanese Poach); Flik Zone Concepts 6. IF Pressing, Traps and Triggers	2s preview in week 30, full in week 39
☐	13 Mar	Wk 25 · 20 Mar	43 Winning the deep ball	GRUT deep videos; HN Practice Sessions 10; HB 27.4–27.5	Both video links
☐	27 Mar	Wk 27 · 3 Apr	33 Zone offence	HN Flik (Dump and Swing, Crashing the Cup, Zone Offence); Flik Zone Offence 1–3, 8, 9; HB 31.2, 33.3. ★ SF How do you actually beat a zone defense?, Running the option against a zone	"Over" stays light until week 34

Done	Write by (w/c)	Release	Card	Read	Check
☐	3 Apr	Wk 28 · 10 Apr	8 The huck	DK 4.7; Flik L4 L4; HN Practice Sessions 9; HN Excel Premium (hucking pages); HN Deep Dives (Ring of Fire). ★ SF Launch angle positive, angle of attack negative	Archery scoring matches the session; links to Cards 41 and 42
☐	3 Apr	Wk 28 · 10 Apr	14 Deep cutting	HN Excel Premium (Deep Cutting, The L Cut, How to Jump); HN Next Gen 10 (Deep Cut Timing); HN 10 Big Drills; HB 27.3–27.4. ★ SF A few tips on cutting deep	L-cut diagram; post with Card 8
☐	8 May	Wk 33 · 15 May	26 Switching	HN Team Defence (switching); HN Flik (Buzz Switch); Ian French (Help the Helper). SF The Some Flow Guide to All Person (AP) Defense	Switch calls agreed by both squads
☐	8 May	Wk 33 · 15 May	34 Force middle and marking options	HN Point of Attack (Force Middle; Anti-Huck; Marking against Hammer; Marking Matchups). IF podcast Forcing Middle and Straight Up	1s only; marking calls repeat in week 39

Phase 4: Regionals (weeks 38–43)

Done	Write by (w/c)	Release	Card	Read	Check
☐	12 Jun	Wk 38 · 19 Jun	40 Scouting and game plans	HN Case Studies (CUSB 2019; Mooncatchers scouting sheet); BFD (Game plans); HN Coach Corner (Base Metric Analysis). IF A Look at JinX (a worked scouting example)	Scouting card template attached; lines up with C9

Refreshers to re-post

No new writing, just a re-read and a short Discord reminder.

Week	Re-post
15 and 32	Card 7 Breaking the mark
22	Cards 19, 27, 28 (full systems week)
27	Card 30 Endzone and Spread
30	Cards 9 and 42 (wind, downwind hucks)
31	Card 29 (pulling technique)
39	Card 44 Marking habits; Card 34 marking calls
Before every event	Card 39 Tournament day

Classroom prep reading

The cards that go with a classroom session (3, 36, 37, 40) are in the tables above. The other sessions need their own reading:

Session	Week	Read
C2 Belonging	7	*The Culture Code*, part 1 (safety); OTF Everybody Makes Mistakes
C3 Leaders, not stars	10	*The Captain Class*; Rise Up: Leadership without an Ego; OTF Team Leadership and Roles, The Inner Game of Captaining
C6 How we review	25	*The Culture Code*, part 2 (vulnerability, candour); OTF Conflict Time!
C7 Purpose	29	*The Culture Code*, part 3 (purpose); *The Captain Class*; Rise Up: Everybody In; OTF Who do we want to be?, Value Inventory
C8 Film session	34	HN Deep Dives and Team Analysis (pick two games); *Inner Game*; IF Develop Field Sense Through Video
C10 Competing with heart	41	*Inner Game*; *The Captain Class*
C11 Nationals mindset	46	*Inner Game*; *The Captain Class*; SF How will you play against someone better than you?
C12 Season review	51	*The Culture Code*; OTF Processing…, Winning is a Finite Resource; IF Measuring Your Progress as a Coach

5. The library

Abbreviations match the cards' Source lines. IF covers both Ian French's book and his Substack; the Substack posts are always given with a title in quotes.

5.1 Coaching manuals

Source	What it is	Best for	Cards
BFD	Bologna Flying Disc, *Elite Coaching Program*	Shared vocabulary, resets and Jedi, the flat mark, the dominator, game plans, team management, S&C	1, 4, 6, 7, 12, 13, 16, 17, 20, 22, 25, 28, 31, 35, 38, 39, 40
DK	James Hall and James Butcher, *DK's Bible* (Mythago Training Manual, 2019)	Five Frisbee Habits, throwing technique, triangle marking, running sessions	1, 4, 6, 7, 8, 9, 15, 20, 21, 27, 35
HB	Hildo Bijl, *Ultimate Trainer's Manual* v2.5	Handler rules, running technique (Tr), catching, resets, sideline play, feedback steps	5, 10, 11, 12, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 19, 21, 22, 28, 30, 33, 38, 43
IF (book)	Ian French, *Games for Coaching Ultimate Frisbee*	The game-based sessions behind most Try it sections; Help the Helper. The long version of his Substack's activities and constraints approach	26 (and most sessions)

5.2 Courses and lesson plans

Source	What it is	Best for	Cards
UAP	The Ultimate Skills Project modules: Catching (Shardlow), Breaking the Mark (Saul), Cutting (Raynor), Changing Direction (Witmer), Marking (Wiseman), Defensive Footwork (Matthews), Handler O and D (Wiggins), Backhand hucks	Technique detail and the benchmarks	5, 7, 10, 11, 12, 17, 20, 21, 22, 24, 41
Flik	Flik lesson plans: Levels 1–4, Zone Concepts, Zone Offence, Case Studies	Lesson-by-lesson progressions and zones	6, 8, 9, 11, 16, 21, 23, 32, 33, 37, 38
SP	Kieran's session plans spreadsheet	3H cutting, Spread, the 4v3 mini	27, 30

5.3 Herd OneNote notebook (HN)

Section	Best for	Cards
Flik pages ("HN Flik")	Systems, cutting, poaching, zones, pulls, give-and-go	6, 12, 13, 17, 18, 19, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30, 31, 32, 33
Excel Premium	Cutting, deep cutting, hucking, reading the disc, Game IQ, common mistakes	5, 6, 8, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 18, 21, 29, 30, 35
Point of Attack	Marking: triangle, by stack, from motion, force middle, the shimmy	4, 20, 22, 34
Practice Sessions (2023)	Herd's own sessions	7, 8, 10, 20, 21, 25, 43
Handler Offense / Handler Situations	Catching, dump swing, give-go moves, pulls, transitions	5, 15, 16, 18, 19, 24, 29
Team Defence	Heads-up D, switching	23, 25, 26
Next Gen Essential 10 / 10 Big Drills	Core drills: breakmark, deep timing, win the box	5, 7, 10, 14, 23
Bull Zone	Herd's 2-3-2 zone	31
Amsterdam Conference (Rise Up talks)	Rookie to Baller, Process over Outcome, Elite Defense, Breaking a Defensive Heart, Army of Dump Defenders; classroom leadership talks	1, 4, 22, 23, 36; C3, C4, C7
Coach Corner	Spirit, mindset, fast break, timeouts, base metrics	2, 3, 24, 37, 39, 40
Deep Dives / Team Analysis / Case Studies	Film of elite teams; how programmes were built	8, 9, 10, 28, 37, 39, 40; C8

5.4 Video, rules and books

Source	What it is	Cards
GRUT	GRUT (Amsterdam) videos, filmed with Flik Ultimate: 9 drills in the drill library, 4 technique videos on cards	Drills: 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 14, 16, 19, 39. Videos: 41, 42, 43, 44
WFDF rules	Rules of Ultimate 2025–2028 and the pocket version	2
The Inner Game of Ultimate Frisbee	Anthony David Adams (2024), after Gallwey	3, 37; C1, C5, C8, C10, C11
The Culture Code	Daniel Coyle (2018)	36; C2, C4, C6, C7, C12

Source	What it is	Cards
The Captain Class	Sam Walker (2017)	C3, C7, C10, C11

5.5 Substacks

From the Substack reading guide, built from the full archives as of 30 October 2026. About 60 posts (the ones linked to cards) were read in part; the rest are summarised from their titles. Treat each as a reason to read the post, not a replacement for it.

Tag	Blog	Author	Posts	Best for
IF	bettereveryday coaching	Ian French	128	Coaching method, activity design, European tournament analysis
SF	Some Flow	LT	226 (about 140 on ultimate)	Detailed technique and tactics, built around film clips and data
OTF	Off-The-Field Guide	Luisa Ruge-Jones	43	Team communication, culture and leadership
BL	Bricklock's Blog	Nicholas Whitlock	15	Throwing technique and NZ tournament diaries

Not covered by the Substacks: Card 9 (wind) and the GRUT cards 41–44. Keep using the other sources for those.

What you can skip: IF tournament previews and daily roundups (about 30 posts); SF book reviews outside sport, politics, aerodynamics, summer-league predictions and data-project posts; BL tournament diaries, unless you want NZ colour ("The Tale of Nationals 2024" and "BIG moves at nationals" are the best).

6. Substack posts by card

Every post from the Substack reading guide, by card. ★ = read first (already in part 4). The rest are for when you want more on a card.

6.1 Start here (Cards 1–3)

Card 1 · The Herd Way - ★ OTF The Team Charter and Team Charter Template: a living document that answers the questions captains keep getting (mission, expectations, inclusion, finances, schedule, roster and playing time). - OTF Who do we want to be? and Value Inventory: what sets a team apart is how it *shows* its values. - OTF Death to Handlers and Cutters: matches "space decides the role". - IF Making Your Teammates Better

Card 2 · Rules and Spirit - ★ IF Teaching Rules and Officiating - ★ OTF Why do athletes take foul calls personally?: useful for the week 1 "freeze" discussions.

Card 3 · How we learn - ★ OTF The Power of Description and Building Description into Your Routines: almost word for word the card's "Notice, don't judge". - ★ IF Drills vs Games: ask "which game?", not "which drill?". - IF Constraints-Led Approach series: intro, applied, individual training, in-game coaching - IF Why You Are In The Intermediate Plateau: for the Next level ladder. - OTF Everybody Makes Mistakes - SF An introduction to the science of learning, for frisbee throwers and The Language of Coaching (external focus and analogy: useful for writing cues). - BL 'Mini' blog: eight mini rule changes, a ready-made constraints toolkit.

6.2 Throw and catch (Cards 4–9)

Card 4 · Grip, pivot and fakes - Clash 1 and the grip posts (part 2). - SF forehand series: How to throw forehands using your elbow, Don't turn the palm up, Forehand: wrist, grip, and wobble, More forehand mechanics that aren't taught, The disc doesn't need to stay flat - SF Start considering your options as early as possible: the inward pivot versus the jump pivot when catching.

Card 5 · Catching - ★ SF 95% of misreads are to the high side - SF Catching well is always important, First run, then catch - IF Catch your Ds and Learning Layouts

Card 6 · Throw to space - ★ IF Good Bad Throws: flat throws to space are your friend. - ★ SF Always be offering: cutters use hand signals to offer space, which also stops defenders poaching. - SF Avoiding thrower/receiver miscommunications, How accurately can you possibly throw a frisbee?, Throw low to high - IF Small Sided Game: Golden Arm/Hand: the source of Golden Hand, so credit it on the card.

Card 7 · Breaking the mark - ★ BL Everyone should be using this drill to become elite: getting the most from the three-person break-mark drill (Classic Breakmark), for thrower and marker. Almost a ready-made Next level. - ★ BL A model for improving at throwing: repetition, variety, applicability. - SF How to practice throwing, The no-windup backhand (the quick-release backhand from Next level). - IF 3 Tips for Intermediate Throwers, Zen Throwing and fixed throwing routines, Creative Scoring Throws

Card 8 · The huck (and 41–42) - ★ SF Launch angle positive, angle of attack negative - SF Keep the disc forward as you bring your elbow back? and Why the palm appears up on flick hucks - BL The interplay between dribbling and hucking: also fits Card 28. - SF San Francisco Fury's stall-zero huck strategy

Card 9 · Wind: none of the four blogs covers wind.

6.3 Get open (Cards 10–14)

Card 10 · First three steps - Clash 2 (part 2). - SF Accelerate as fast as you possibly can

Card 11 · Getting open (the biggest cluster) - ★ SF Great cutters fake and do other things well too: summarises all of LT's cutting articles. Read this one if you only read one. - ★ SF Cut before the thrower catches it: backs Card 6. - ★ SF Don't not get thrown to: a failed 3-second under cut is 30% of a stall. - SF Getting open by stopping and Stop-and-Go: a "wait" option. - SF Walking before cutting, part II, Feign boredom: together they match "jog, jab, sprint". - SF Notice when your defender isn't noticing you, The "fake clear" cut, Pretending to call for the disc, Reading the mark defender as a cutter - IF Early Positioning gets the disc

Card 12 · Clearing - ★ SF Clear out, don't check out: catchy enough to be the Next level cue. - SF Let your teammates be open: matches "never more than two in a space".

Card 13 · Reading the pitch - ★ IF Scanning the Field and Soft vs Hard Eyes - ★ SF Soft eyes, quiet eyes, scanning eyes: LT's reply to Ian; read the two together. - IF Develop Field Sense Through Video: your water-break screenshot game. Credit it. - SF "How do I improve my field sense?", Mental games to build your field sense, Oodles of OODAs (a cousin of read, process, move), Elite players looking away from the disc, Think about what your opponent is thinking

Card 14 · Deep cutting - ★ SF A few tips on cutting deep: backs "first five steps head down". - SF 32 seconds of Cal Nightingale continuation cutting genius: film study for the L cut.

6.4 Handle and reset (Cards 15–19)

Cards 15–16 · Handler's job and resets - Clash 4 (part 2). - ★ SF You don't need to stare down your dump receiver - ★ SF Don't lose more yards than necessary on dump throws: fits "positive" resets. - SF The box-out dump cut

Card 17 · Beating a good mark - ★ SF Catching with momentum towards the break side: the "functional break". - SF Beat the upline switch with a breakside fade

Card 18 · Sideline - SF Caring about getting downfield of the disc: the stats on offence trapped on the line.

Card 19 · Give-and-go - ★ SF The go-to give-go resource - SF Defending the Dribble: the defensive side, useful for Card 26's buzz switch. - SF Point five frisbee and More stall zero hammers, please!

6.5 Defend (Cards 20–26)

Card 20 · Marks - Clash 3 (part 2). - SF How to get handblocks like John McDonnell - IF 5 Short Notes: marking, plus vert stack poaches.

Card 21 · Footwork - ★ SF Backpedaling, defensive awareness, and gaining an edge: strong support for "never turn your back on the disc". - SF My philosophies on: playing defense

Card 22 · Reading the thrower - IF Changing Defensive Rules: rule changes that create more blocks. - SF Use your opponent's expectations against them

Card 23 · Downfield D - ★ SF Why you shouldn't always play tight defense: "can I get to the disc before the disc gets to my player?" Fits the buffer idea. - ★ SF Thinking carefully about defensive overplays - IF 2 Advanced Defensive Concepts: "one and a half person defence". Fits Card 23 or 25. - IF Force Unforced Errors

Card 24 · Transition - Clash 5 (part 2). - ★ IF The key to fast break offence and EUCF Final: CUSB Break Efficiency (CUSB again, a link to Card 40). - SF Fury's fast breaks, Brute Squad's fast break ferocity, The 'post-huck' fast break, Defender on the ground? Get rid of the disc!, Replies to feedback on my "fast break" video - SF Caring about getting downfield of the disc: "mini-transitions" on every throw.

Card 25 · Poach and clog - ★ SF Stunt and recover: "flash the lane", with better vocabulary. - SF There's still alpha in help defense, Fury's defense will ignore your weakest link, The art of beating the help defense back to the second option

Card 26 · Switching - SF The Some Flow Guide to All Person (AP) Defense: about 4,800 words; read before week 33. - See also Defending the Dribble (Card 19) and the upline switch (Card 17).

6.6 Herd systems (Cards 27–34)

Cards 27–28 · Vert, horo, dominator - ★ IF Tactics aren't shapes and Tactics are Overrated - SF The best offense is no offense - SF Organizing my thoughts on playing offense, Against starting your offense with something hard, Reject the patriarchy, play flow offense, Slowing at the saddle point

Card 29 · Pulls (a strong cluster) - ★ IF Conor Hogan's Pulling Thoughts (about 4,300 words) and the podcast - IF Judging Good Pulls - SF PUL's Pulls, Why collecting pulls matters, Pull catching inversions, A quick tip on catching pulls: get to the sideline, Catch the centering pass facing forwards (the "2" role), I still think it's crazy you're falling for these pull plays

Card 30 · Endzone - ★ SF "Endzone!" doesn't need to mean "vert stack": directly relevant to our two calls. - SF Putting your whole offense in the endzone is bad, actually and You don't have to walk the disc to the front of the endzone

Cards 31–32 · Zones - SF My summer league zone defense: compare with our far wing. - IF Pressing, Traps and Triggers: fits the line trap and Card 40's triggers.

Card 33 · Zone offence - ★ SF How do you actually beat a zone defense? and Running the option against a zone - SF Tom Blasman Hammers (data on upside-down throws) and More women throwing hammers, please! - IF Zone Offence Moves I Like

Card 34 · Force middle - IF podcast Forcing Middle and Straight Up - IF Choosing defensive tactics

6.7 Compete (Cards 35–40)

Card 35 · Good throw vs good decision - ★ SF Why do turnovers happen?: a model for the decision grid. - SF Turnover analysis has its limits and Don't overreact when it's all the same bell curve - OTF Why don't we throw to FMPs?: a decision-making issue as well as an inclusion one, if Herd plays mixed.

Card 36 · Process over outcome - ★ OTF Letting Go of Outcomes and Winning is a Finite Resource - IF Training Journal for Ultimate: could be the process-goal tracker. - IF Measuring Your Progress as a Coach - SF Accumulating marginal gains and Balancing individual growth and winning

Card 37 · Pressure - ★ OTF You've got me feeling emotions! - ★ IF Trials and Selection: share it with C5, before trials. - SF Reframing frustration, Being competitive includes your emotions, Book review: The Upside of Stress (the science behind "I'm not nervous, I'm excited"), How will you play against someone better than you? - IF Integrating Mental Training into Practice

Card 38 · Sideline - Clash 6 (part 2). - ★ OTF Do you practice communicating? and Adding Communication Practice to Drills: a talk break between points that slots into any session. - IF Positive Interventions: supports "specific praise".

Card 39 · Tournament day - ★ IF Using Timeouts Effectively - ★ OTF Staying True to Your Team: don't change lines, playing time or systems in the post-season. Read it before Regionals. - IF Early Season Tournament Strategy: matches Solent and Tour 1. - IF WUCC Reflections 1, 2, 3: coaching GRUT game by game. Also IF World Games parts 1–3. - OTF Well I'm burning out… (mid-season) and Processing… (end of season)

Card 40 · Scouting and game plans - IF A Look at JinX: a worked scouting example. - IF Beating a team twice and Saving Your Best For Last - SF The PUL's end-of-game strategic awareness remains disappointing: game-state decisions; also fits Card 35's Next level.

6.8 For coaches and captains (not card material)

Topic	When	Read
Leadership group	Start of season (Nov 2026 pass, then C3)	OTF Team Leadership and Roles, Make Good Choices, New Year, New Team, The Inner Game of Captaining
Building the squad	Around trials (weeks 14–24)	OTF Swift Trust, 3 Things That Help Build Trust, Forming, Storming, Norming, Performing (a good classroom slot around trials), Roster Games, Healthy Competition
Conflict	Weeks 18–25; expect the first fight around the second tournament	OTF Conflict Time!, Conflict Practice
Commitment and retention	Any time; 44 players, two squads	OTF Frost the Flakes, Player Retention, Player Development 101
Inclusion	Any time	OTF Why does DEI matter in ultimate?, Stories Towards Inclusion 1 and 2
Your own coaching	Off-season (Aug 2027) and after the season	IF Why You Aren't Getting Better As A Coach 1 and 2; Coach Improvement in the Offseason, Evaluating Session Content, Season Planning, How I Train Different Group Sizes, How to be a good Player-Coach; BL BIG Steppers
Mid-season	Weeks 26–34	OTF Well I'm burning out…
Players in the off-season	Share in the Christmas break and after the season	IF Offseason Advice Pt.1, Pt.2: Solo Skill Training, Solo Training Tips; SF Get better at frisbee without leaving your room, Playing pickup with intention